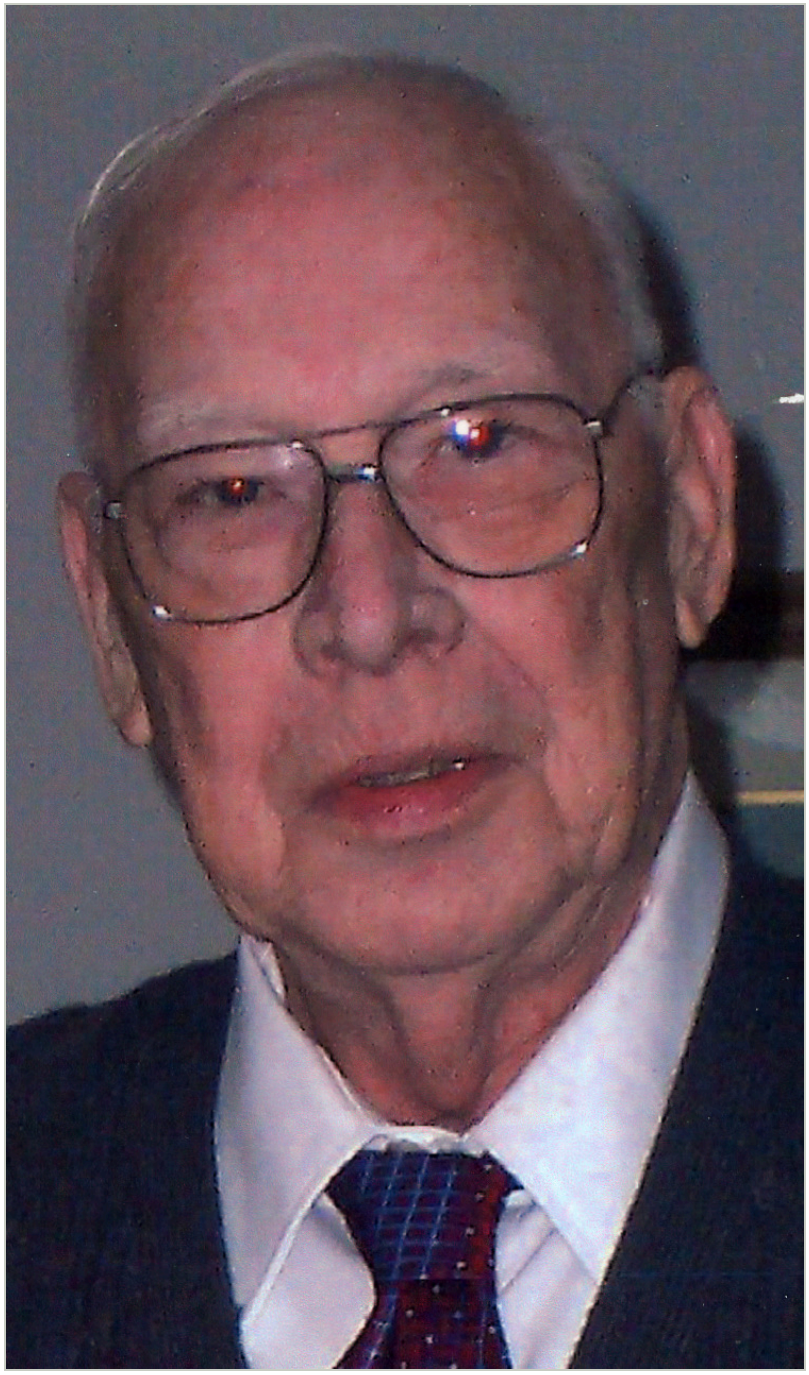
GRACE'S FATHER-IN-LAW · A FAMILY FROM THE RECORDS

Michael Bauer Smith Sr.

Terre Haute, Indiana, 2 December 1949 · Santa Clara · San Mateo. The son of a Terre Haute laboratory technician who became a Sunnyvale rocket-plant technician, and of an upholsterer's daughter from Poplar Street; the grandson of a First World War private and a Lower Austrian immigrant; a sergeant of the 173d Airborne Brigade in Vietnam, wounded and decorated in 1970; the husband of Betty Goodwin and the father of Michael, Jason, Robert, Dawn and Michelle. Four generations of his people lived in Terre Haute, and this page follows them back to Kentucky, Ohio and a village on the Danube.

Compiled 4 and 5 September 2026 for the Smith and Goodwin families by Grace Marie Goodwin, from the census, the Vigo County records, the Army's files and draft cards, the Terre Haute Star and Tribune, the National Archives and the cemeteries of Terre Haute and Santa Clara; revised 22 October 2026 from Michael's own memoir, Echoes of a Sky Soldier, written with Branding by Books.

2 Dec 1949 born at St. Anthony's Hospital, Terre Haute	**1883** Anton Bauer born at Frauendorf, Lower Austria	**1970** Bronze Star and Purple Heart, 173d Airborne Brigade	**26** months Ralph served, 1st Cavalry Division
54 years Ralph and Patricia were married	**5** children: Michael, Jason, Robert, Dawn, Michelle		



Ralph Warren Smith, 1926 to 2012. Michael's father, born on a Honey Creek Township coal miner's place, a private of the 1st Cavalry Division at nineteen, a technician at the United Technology Center rocket plant in Sunnyvale for the better part of twenty years. The photograph from his Find a Grave memorial.

THIRTEEN CHAPTERS

The family, in order

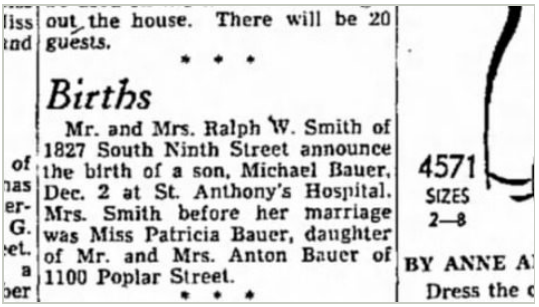
Everything below rests on a record named in the sources at the end; where the records fall silent, or where the family's own knowledge is the only source, the text says so. Michael is

living, and his own chapters keep to what he and his family have said: most of it now comes from his memoir, Echoes of a Sky Soldier, written with Branding by Books in 2024 to 2026.

TERRE HAUTE, INDIANA, 2 DECEMBER 1949

A son, Michael Bauer, at St. Anthony's Hospital

Michael Bauer Smith was born on Friday, 2 December 1949, at St. Anthony's Hospital in Terre Haute, Indiana, the first child of Ralph Warren Smith, 23, and Patricia Antoinette Bauer, 21, who had been married a year and a half. The Terre Haute Star printed the news the following Saturday in its Births column, three lines that carry the whole of one side of this page: 'Mr. and Mrs. Ralph W. Smith of 1827 South Ninth Street announce the birth of a son, Michael Bauer, Dec. 2 at St. Anthony's Hospital. Mrs. Smith before her marriage was Miss Patricia Bauer, daughter of Mr. and Mrs. Anton Bauer of 1100 Poplar Street.' His middle name is his mother's maiden name, and it belongs to the Bauers of Poplar Street, an upholsterer from Lower Austria and the Terre Haute girl he married in 1908.


out the house. There will be 20 guests.

* * *

Births

Mr. and Mrs. Ralph W. Smith of 1827 South Ninth Street announce the birth of a son, Michael Bauer, Dec. 2 at St. Anthony's Hospital. Mrs. Smith before her marriage was Miss Patricia Bauer, daughter of Mr. and Mrs. Anton Bauer of 1100 Poplar Street.

* * *

4571
SIZES
2—8

The Terre Haute Star, Saturday, 10 December 1949, page 5: 'Mr. and Mrs. Ralph W. Smith of 1827 South Ninth Street announce the birth of a son, Michael Bauer, Dec. 2 at St. Anthony's Hospital. Mrs. Smith before her marriage was Miss Patricia Bauer, daughter of Mr. and Mrs. Anton Bauer of 1100 Poplar Street.'

The address tells its own story. Fifteen months earlier, when Ralph registered for the peacetime draft, he had given his mother Jessie Smith's address as 1827 South Ninth Street, so the young couple were living with Ralph's parents, Pearl and Jessie, when the baby came. By the spring they had a place of their own, of a kind. The census taker who climbed the stairs at 43 South 15th Street on 3 April 1950 wrote the household down as '43, upstairs': Ralph W. Smith, 23, head, a laboratory technician at a 'wholesale chemical products producing plant,' 46 hours the week before; Patricia A., 22, wife; and 'Michael B., son,' with 'Dec.' written where his age should go, the month of his birth, as the census takers were told to do for babies under a year old. At '43, back,' in the rear of the same house, lived Patricia's brother Anton J. Bauer Jr., 28, an upholsterer like his father, with his wife Virginia, who ran a bottling machine at a wholesale distillery, and their two small children. The rooms had been advertised in the Tribune the September before, under Apartments for Rent: '43 S. 15th. 2 unfurnished modern rooms. Share bath. Prefer couple with child.'

The Terre Haute that Michael was born into was a factory and railroad town of 64,000 on the Wabash, with the Commercial Solvents plant, where his father had worked since at least 1948, turning out industrial alcohol and, since the war, penicillin; it was the town where every one of his grandparents and great-

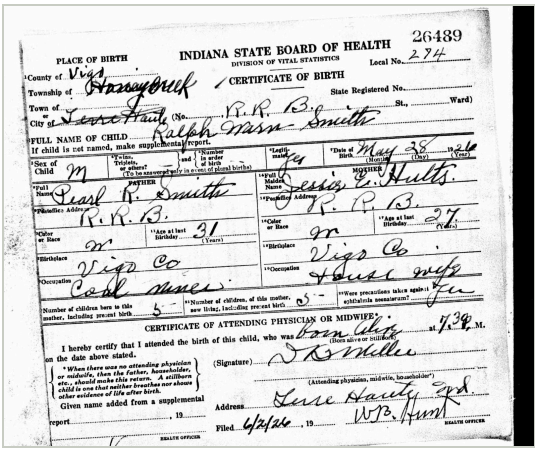
grandparents on both sides had lived for the best part of a century, and where his great-grandfather Anton Bauer still ran an upholstery shop on Poplar Street at 66, sixty hours a week. While Michael was still a boy the family went west, and the rest of his own story belongs to California and to the people who can tell it: Santa Clara as a boy, the service and a paratrooper's wings in the Vietnam years, and more than thirty years in San Mateo with Betty and their children. This page is about where he came from.

HONEY CREEK TOWNSHIP, 1926 TO 1944

Ralph Warren Smith, a coal miner's son on Spring Hill Road

Michael's father, Ralph Warren Smith, was born on 28 May 1926 in Honey Creek Township, the farming and coal country just south of Terre Haute, the fifth and last child of Pearl Ruby Smith and Jessie Ethel Hults. The certificate the doctor filed spells him 'Ralph Warn Smith,' gives his father's occupation as coal miner, and notes that all five of Jessie's children were living; the family would later turn the names around and call him Warren, which is how the 1940 census taker heard it. His birthday was one of the small facts he adjusted for the Army: on both of his draft cards he was born on 15 May 1926, and on his marriage license at eighteen he was born in 1923, but the birth certificate, his obituary and his headstone all say 28 May.

In April 1930 the census found the family on Spring Hill Road in Honey Creek Township: Pearl, 35, and Jessie, 31, with Jessie Maxine, 11, Richard Eugene, 9, Paul, 7, Donald, 6, and Ralph, 3. They were on a farm in 1935 and still in Honey Creek in 1940, when Ralph at 13 had finished the seventh grade. By the time he registered for the draft on 15 May 1944 the family's address was Rural Route 2, Box 156, Terre Haute, telephone C-63257, and the registrar of Local Board No. 4 at 819 Ohio Street described him as six feet tall and 165 pounds, with brown hair, blue eyes and a light complexion; his next of kin was his father Pearl. He had four years of high school by the time the Army took him that autumn.

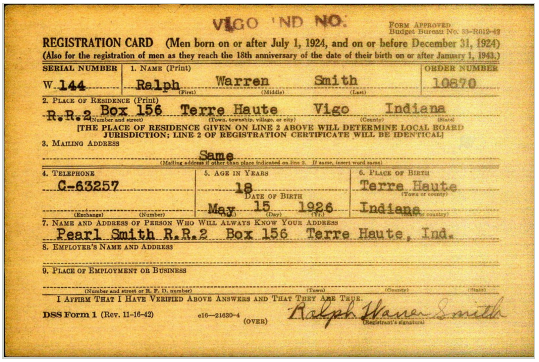

INDIANA STATE BOARD OF HEALTH 26489
DIVISION OF VITAL STATISTICS
CERTIFICATE OF BIRTH
PLACE OF BIRTH
FULL NAME OF CHILD
Ralph Warn Smith
Pearl R. Smith
Jessie E. Hults
28 May 1926
Vigo Co
Coal miner
House wife
CERTIFICATE OF ATTENDING PHYSICIAN OR MIDWIFE
D. B. Miller
Terre Haute Ind.
Filed 6/2/26

Indiana certificate of birth no. 26489, filed 2 June 1926: 'Ralph Warn Smith,' born alive at 7:30 in the morning of 28 May 1926 on a rural route in Honey Creek Township, the fifth child of Pearl R. Smith, 31, coal miner, and Jessie E. Hults, 27, housewife, all five children living; D. B. Miller of Terre Haute attending. Indiana Archives and Records Administration, via Ancestry.

INDIANAPOLIS TO TOKYO, 1944 TO 1946

Private Smith, 35908327, 1st Cavalry Division

Ralph was inducted into the Army of the United States at Indianapolis on 9 September 1944, three months after his eighteenth birthday, a private, single, with four years of high school, serial number 35908327. The Army's own record of his service is thin, since his personnel file has not been found, but the draft card he filled out in 1948 sets down the frame of it in his own words: active duty from 9 September 1944, the Army, the 1st Cavalry Division, discharged 22 November 1946. Twenty-six months.


VIGO IND NO.

REGISTRATION CARD (Men born on or after July 1, 1924, and on or before December 31, 1924)
(Also for the registration of men as they reach the 18th anniversary of the date of their birth on or after January 1, 1943.)

SERIAL NUMBER W-144 | 1. NAME (Print): Ralph Warren Smith | ORDER NUMBER 10870

2. PLACE OF RESIDENCE (Print): R.R.2 Box 156 Terre Haute Vigo Indiana
[THE PLACE OF RESIDENCE GIVEN ON LINE 2 ABOVE WILL DETERMINE LOCAL BOARD JURISDICTION; LINE 2 OF REGISTRATION CERTIFICATE WILL BE IDENTICAL]

3. MAILING ADDRESS: Same

4. TELEPHONE: C-63257 | 5. AGE IN YEARS: 18 | DATE OF BIRTH: May 15 1926 | 6. PLACE OF BIRTH: Terre Haute Indiana

7. NAME AND ADDRESS OF PERSON WHO WILL ALWAYS KNOW YOUR ADDRESS: Pearl Smith R.R.2 Box 156 Terre Haute, Ind.

8. EMPLOYER'S NAME AND ADDRESS

9. PLACE OF EMPLOYMENT OR BUSINESS

I AFFIRM THAT I HAVE VERIFIED ABOVE ANSWERS AND THAT THEY ARE TRUE. Ralph Warren Smith (Registrant's signature)

DSS Form 1 (Rev. 11-16-42) 216—21632-4 (OVER)

Ralph's draft registration card, Vigo County Local Board No. 4, 15 May 1944, serial number W-144, order number 10870, in his own signature: 'Ralph Warren Smith.' National Archives, via Ancestry.

The 1st Cavalry Division was in the Philippines when Ralph went into uniform. It had landed on Leyte in October 1944 and on Luzon in January 1945, and its flying column was the first American unit into Manila on 3 February 1945; three weeks later, on 23 February, with General MacArthur looking on from the background of the Signal Corps photograph, its 12th Cavalry raised the flag over the recaptured Manila Hotel, and its troopers guarded the Japanese prisoners who buried the dead at the Santo Tomas camp. When Japan surrendered the division went ashore at Yokohama and, on 8 September 1945, became the first division to enter Tokyo, where it stayed as an occupation force for five years. A soldier who enlisted in September 1944 would have finished his training early in 1945 and shipped out as a replacement, joining the division either in the last fighting on Luzon that spring or in Japan that autumn; the discharge fourteen months after the war ended points to the occupation, a nineteen-year-old from Honey Creek Township walking the streets of Tokyo. Which of those it was, his own discharge papers would say, and they are among the things this page still has to find. The Signal Corps photographs of the division in Manila in 1945 and on review in Tokyo in May 1946, in the gallery below, show the war he went to. Michael's memoir adds what the family remembers. Before Michael shipped out for Vietnam, his father taught him the things he had learned 'from combat in the Philippines,' how to read a hillside from the top and where an ambush would be laid, which puts Ralph on Luzon in the spring of 1945 and not only in Japan; and the family remembers both Ralph and his father Pearl as sergeants, where the records found so far have both as privates. His discharge papers would settle it.

He came home once in the middle of it. On 26 January 1945, four and a half months after his induction, Ralph W. Smith, 'age 22, born 15 May 1923,' married Florence Jane Francis, a Prairieton Township girl a few months younger than himself, in Vigo County. He was

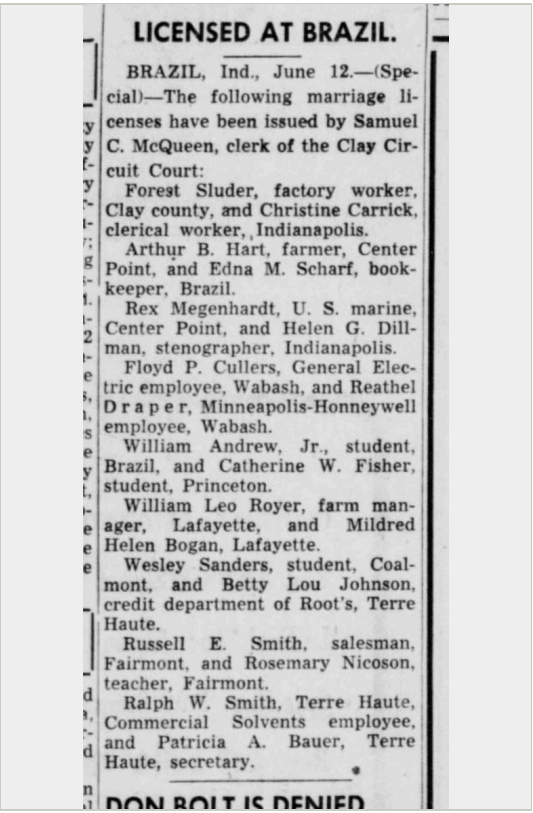
eighteen; the extra years were for the license. It was a wartime furlough wedding, and it did not survive the war. By 1948 they were divorced, and in April 1949 Florence married Richard Norman Fields. The story has a coda sixty years on.

TERRE HAUTE, 1948

A watchman at Commercial Solvents marries a secretary from Poplar Street

Ralph came back to Terre Haute and to work at the Commercial Solvents Corporation, the chemical plant at First and Washington that had made solvents and industrial alcohol from corn since the First World War and penicillin since the Second. The couple took out their license not in Terre Haute but across the county line at Brazil, in Clay County, and on 13 June 1948 the Tribune's list of licenses issued by Samuel C. McQueen, clerk of the Clay Circuit Court, ended with 'Ralph W. Smith, Terre Haute, Commercial Solvents employee, and Patricia A. Bauer, Terre Haute, secretary.' They had been married on 28 May 1948, his twenty-second birthday; the record gives her parents as Anton Bauer and Belle Bean, the clerk's spelling of Beam, and his as Pearl R. Smith and Jessie E. Hults. She was twenty, born on 1 March 1928, the tenth of the eleven Bauer children.

When Ralph registered again under the new draft law on 8 September 1948, at 506 North Seventh Street, he was married, a watchman for Commercial Solvents at First and Washington, six feet and 170 pounds, brown hair, blue eyes, fair, and the person who would always know his address was his mother, Jessie Smith, 1827 South Ninth Street. The card, which survives at the National Archives in St. Louis, is the one document in which he wrote down his own war: Army, 9 September 1944 to 22 November 1946, 1st Cavalry Division. By the census of 1950 he had moved up to laboratory technician at the same plant. Michael was born between the two registrations and the census.



LICENSED AT BRAZIL.

BRAZIL, Ind., June 12.—(Special)—The following marriage licenses have been issued by Samuel C. McQueen, clerk of the Clay Circuit Court:

Forest Sluder, factory worker, Clay county, and Christine Carrick, clerical worker, Indianapolis.

Arthur B. Hart, farmer, Center Point, and Edna M. Scharf, bookkeeper, Brazil.

Rex Megenhardt, U. S. marine, Center Point, and Helen G. Dillman, stenographer, Indianapolis.

Floyd P. Cullers, General Electric employee, Wabash, and Reathel Draper, Minneapolis-Honneywell employee, Wabash.

William Andrew, Jr., student, Brazil, and Catherine W. Fisher, student, Princeton.

William Leo Royer, farm manager, Lafayette, and Mildred Helen Bogan, Lafayette.

Wesley Sanders, student, Coalmont, and Betty Lou Johnson, credit department of Root's, Terre Haute.

Russell E. Smith, salesman, Fairmont, and Rosemary Nicoson, teacher, Fairmont.

Ralph W. Smith, Terre Haute, Commercial Solvents employee, and Patricia A. Bauer, Terre Haute, secretary.

DON BOLT IS DENIED

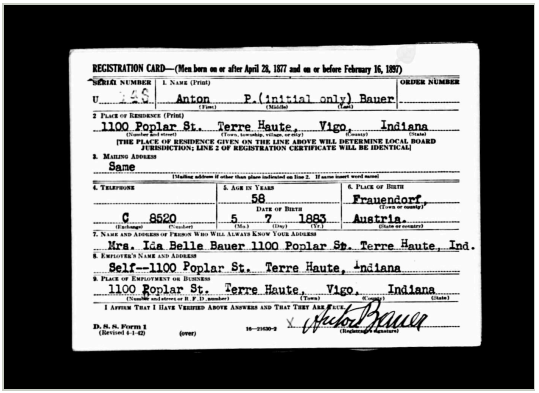
The Terre Haute Tribune, Sunday, 13 June 1948, page 33: marriage licenses issued by Samuel C. McQueen, clerk of the Clay Circuit Court at Brazil, ending with 'Ralph W. Smith, Terre Haute, Commercial Solvents employee, and Patricia A. Bauer, Terre Haute, secretary.'

FRAUENDORF TO POPLAR STREET, 1883 TO 1908

Anton Bauer, the upholsterer from Lower Austria

Michael's grandfather Anton Bauer was born on 7 May 1883 at Frauendorf, a farming village of a few hundred people in the Tullnerfeld, the flat, fertile plain along the Danube east of Traismauer in Lower Austria, an hour from Vienna. His parents were Florian Bauer, born in 1844, and Barbara Crites, as the Terre Haute registrar spelled her name on his death certificate ninety-four years later, born in 1850; the cousins' trees on Ancestry give the parents' deaths at Frauendorf in 1927 and 1935, so they stayed. The village belonged to the parish of Stollhofen, whose baptismal register for 1881 to 1907 is online at the Diocese of St. Poelten's Matricula archive and should hold his christening, in the priest's Latin, with his godparents and the house number; that is one of the pages still to be read. His brothers and sisters scattered the way Austrian villagers did in those years: Josephine, born 1876, and Florian, born 1890, both died in Tuscarawas County, Ohio, and Theresia, born 1879, died at Frauendorf in 1973.

Anton left for America in 1901, at eighteen, and by the spring of 1908 he was in Terre Haute; on 14 May 1908 he married Ida Belle Beam there, a wagon maker's daughter of eighteen, and the 1910 census found them at 309 Poplar Street with a year-old daughter, Anna Belle, Anton an upholsterer for a dry goods store, renting, 26, 'born Germany' to the enumerator's ear, which in Terre Haute was how an Austrian's accent sounded. Michael grew up with the same idea, that his grandfather had been born in Germany, and as an Army recruit in 1968 hoped to be posted there on that account; his mother spoke of her father as an Austrian immigrant, and the records agree with her. He registered for the draft on 12 September 1918, at 35, an upholsterer working for himself at 1100 Poplar Street, a declarant alien with 'Austria' written in for the nation whose subject he still was; the registrar found him short, of medium build and blue-eyed, and where the form asked for the colour of his hair wrote 'slightly bald.' 1100 Poplar was the family's address for the next forty years. The censuses watch the shop grow: a finisher in a furniture factory in 1920; by 1930 an upholsterer 'working on own account' in a shop of his own, owning the house, valued at $5,000; in 1940 the proprietor of an upholstery business, eight years of schooling, fifty hours a week; and in 1950, at 66, still 'repairing and upholstering' in his own shop, sixty hours a week, with Ida Belle, their son Joseph, 20, their daughter Helen McGee and her two-year-old Mary under the same roof.



REGISTRATION CARD—(Men born on or after April 28, 1877 and on or before February 16, 1897)

SERIAL NUMBER U 168 — 1. NAME (Print): Anton (First) P.(initial only) (Middle) Bauer (Last) — ORDER NUMBER

2. PLACE OF RESIDENCE (Print): 1100 Poplar St. (Number and street) Terre Haute, (Town, township, village or city) Vigo, (County) Indiana (State)

[THE PLACE OF RESIDENCE GIVEN ON THE LINE ABOVE WILL DETERMINE LOCAL BOARD JURISDICTION; LINE 2 OF REGISTRATION CERTIFICATE WILL BE IDENTICAL]

3. MAILING ADDRESS: Same (Mailing address if other than place indicated on line 2. If none insert word none)

4. TELEPHONE: C 8520 (Exchange) (Number) — 5. AGE IN YEARS: 58 — DATE OF BIRTH: 5 (Mo.) 7 (Day) 1883 (Yr.) — 6. PLACE OF BIRTH: Frauendorf, (Town or county) Austria. (State or country)

7. NAME AND ADDRESS OF PERSON WHO WILL ALWAYS KNOW YOUR ADDRESS: Mrs. Ida Belle Bauer 1100 Poplar St. Terre Haute, Ind.

8. EMPLOYER'S NAME AND ADDRESS: Self--1100 Poplar St. Terre Haute, Indiana

9. PLACE OF EMPLOYMENT OR BUSINESS: 1100 Poplar St. (Number and street or R. F. D. number) Terre Haute, (Town) Vigo. (County) Indiana (State)

I AFFIRM THAT I HAVE VERIFIED ABOVE ANSWERS AND THAT THEY ARE TRUE. X Victor Bauer (Registrant's signature)

D. S. S. Form 1 (Revised 1-1-42) (over) 16—21630-2

Anton P. Bauer's registration card of 1942, the 'old man's draft' for men born between 1877 and 1897: born 7 May 1883 at Frauendorf, Austria, of 1100 Poplar Street, Terre Haute, next of kin Mrs. Ida Belle Bauer. National Archives, via Ancestry.

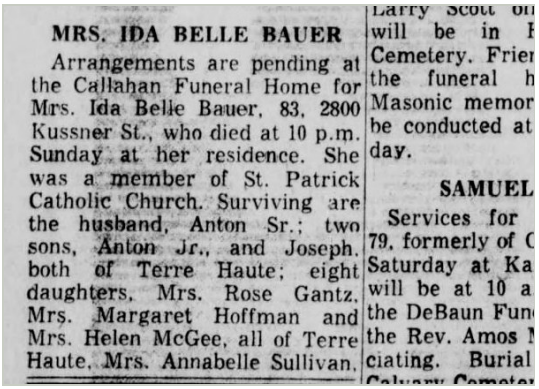
The Terre Haute Tribune carried his shop's line in the classifieds through the 1950s, under the heading Upholstery, Repairing: 'Upholstering, refinishing and repairs. Anton Bauer, 1100 Poplar. C-8520.' The telephone number is the one he had given on his draft card in 1942. On 10 May 1971 the Tribune's 'Nosey News Hawk' column of local notes recorded that 'Anton Bauer, 2800 Kussner Ave., celebrated his 88th birthday last Friday. A life-long resident of Terre Haute, he was owner and operator of the Anton Bauer Upholstery Co. for years. Now retired, he keeps busy in his large garden.' He died in Terre Haute on 2 March 1977, at 93, and was buried with Ida Belle in Calvary Cemetery, the Catholic cemetery, under a stone that gives their years and a cross. His citizenship is a small puzzle: the 1920 census called him naturalized, the 1930 census an alien, the 1940 census a man with first papers, and the 1950 census a citizen. An Anton Bauer 'born 1883 in Austria, arrived 1900' was naturalized at Milwaukee on 14 June 1906, and one family tree has attached that record to him, but another Anton Bauer of the same age, born in Bohemia, was living in Milwaukee in 1910 and died there in 1968, and the Milwaukee paper is more likely his.

POPLAR STREET, 1909 TO 1973

Ida Belle Beam and the house of eleven children

Ida Belle Beam, Michael's grandmother, was born on 6 August 1889 in Indiana, the eldest child of Jacob Beam, a wagon maker born in Indiana in November 1851, and Emma Alice Winters, whom he had married in Vigo County on 12 November 1888. The 1900 census found the Beams renting at 1910 Eighteenth Street in Terre Haute, Jacob 48 at his trade, with Lillian, 10, which was Ida Belle's first name on paper, Ruby, 7, and James, 3. Her cousins on Ancestry know her as Lillian Ida Belle; her husband's draft cards, the census and her own death certificate call her Ida Belle, and so did the Tribune.

Between 1909 and 1929 she had eleven children at 1100 Poplar Street: Anna Belle in January 1909, Margaret in 1911, a son Anton who lived from August 1912 to June 1913, Frances Josephine in 1914, Rose Marie in 1916, Mary Elizabeth in 1919, Anton Joseph junior in 1920, Helen Angela in 1923, Betty about 1925, Patricia Antoinette on 1 March 1928, and Joseph Anton in May 1929. Ten of them were alive when the census taker counted the house in 1930, from Annabelle, 21, to Joseph, 0, and six of them, Mary, Anton



MRS. IDA BELLE BAUER

Arrangements are pending at the Callahan Funeral Home for Mrs. Ida Belle Bauer, 83, 2800 Kussner St., who died at 10 p.m. Sunday at her residence. She was a member of St. Patrick Catholic Church. Surviving are the husband, Anton Sr.; two sons, Anton Jr., and Joseph, both of Terre Haute; eight daughters, Mrs. Rose Gantz, Mrs. Margaret Hoffman and Mrs. Helen McGee, all of Terre Haute, Mrs. Annabelle Sullivan, Larry Scott of[illegible] will be in [illegible] Cemetery. Frien the funeral h Masonic memor be conducted at day.

SAMUEL

Services for 79, formerly of [illegible] Saturday at Ka will be at 10 a the DeBaun Fun the Rev. Amos [illegible] ciating. Burial [illegible]

The Terre Haute Tribune, Monday, 26 March 1973, page 2: 'Arrangements are pending at the Callahan Funeral Home for Mrs. Ida Belle Bauer, 83, 2800 Kussner St., who died at 10 p.m. Sunday at her residence.' The column runs into an advertisement in the middle of the list of eight daughters.

junior, Helen, Betty, Patricia and Joseph, were still at home with their parents in 1940. The family were parishioners of St. Patrick's, the Catholic church a few blocks from the house.

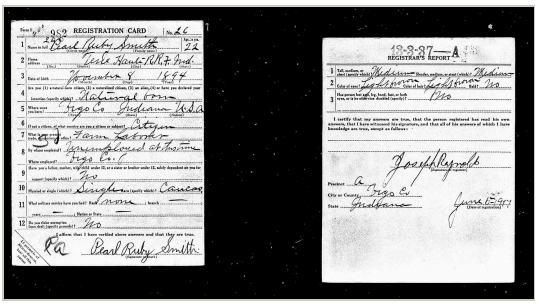
Ida Belle died at 10 o'clock on the night of Sunday, 25 March 1973, at 83, at home at 2800 Kussner Street, where she and Anton had moved after the shop closed. The Tribune's notice the next day listed 'the husband, Anton Sr.; two sons, Anton Jr. and Joseph, both of Terre Haute; eight daughters, Mrs. Rose Gantz, Mrs. Margaret Hoffman and Mrs. Helen McGee, all of Terre Haute, Mrs. Annabelle Sullivan,' and the rest, where the column runs into a funeral home's advertisement; the eight daughters living were Annabelle, Margaret, Frances, Rose, Mary, Helen, Betty and Patricia, the last of them by then a Santa Clara, California, housewife of 45. The services began at the Callahan Funeral Home at half past nine on the Wednesday morning, the Mass of the Resurrection followed at ten at St. Patrick's, and she was buried at Calvary. Anton followed her four years later, almost to the month.

HONEY CREEK TOWNSHIP AND THE OHIO RIVER, 1894 TO 1919

Pearl Ruby Smith: a farm boy's name, a private's war and a wedding at the river

Michael's grandfather Pearl Ruby Smith was born on 8 November 1894 in Vigo County, the second child of Garrett R. Smith and Sarah Elizabeth Killen, and he carried a name that the census takers never got used to: the enumerator of 1900, finding a five-year-old Pearl in Garrett's house in Honey Creek Township, wrote 'daughter.' He grew up on rented farms south of Terre Haute, at Honey Creek in 1900 and Riley in 1910, one of six children.

On 5 June 1917 he registered for the draft at Terre Haute, 22, single, a farm laborer 'unemployed at this time,' living on Rural Route 7, of medium height and build with light brown hair and light brown eyes, and on 21 September 1917 the Army took him: Private Pearl R. Smith, serial number 1,986,564. The Indiana men called up that September went, for the most part, to Camp Zachary Taylor at Louisville, Kentucky, the new cantonment where the 84th Division was being built, and the date and place of his wedding fit that camp. On 24 November 1917, nine weeks after he went into the Army and two weeks after the 84th Division was photographed on review at



Pearl Ruby Smith's draft registration card, Vigo County, 5 June 1917: 22, single, a farm laborer 'unemployed at this time,' on Rural Route 7 out of Terre Haute; medium height and build, light brown eyes and light brown hair. National Archives, via Ancestry.

Camp Taylor, Pearl married Jessie Ethel Hults, 19, in Clark County, Indiana, which is Jeffersonville, across the Ohio River from Louisville and the camp. She had come down from Terre Haute to marry him before he went overseas. He was discharged on 18 April 1919, after nineteen months, long enough for a tour in France with the 84th or with one of the divisions its men were sent to fill, and in March 1978 Jessie, from 1821 South Ninth Street, applied for the government marker that says all she asked it to say: Pvt, US Army, World War I.

Their first child, Jessie Maxine, was born on 2 January 1919 while he was still in uniform. Richard Eugene followed in 1921, Paul in 1922, Donald Garrett in 1923 and Ralph Warren in 1926, the year Pearl gave his trade as coal miner, and the family lived on Spring Hill Road in Honey Creek Township through the thirties. The marriage broke in the last year of the Second World War, when a Vigo County court divorced them in November 1944, two months after Ralph left for the Army, and it mended: on 8 November 1945 Pearl R. Smith and Jessie E. Smith, 47, of Terre Haute, married each other again. Pearl died in Terre Haute on 15 March 1978, at 83, and Jessie on 1 September 1991, at 93, 'widow of Pearl R. Smith,' as the Indianapolis Star's list of Indiana deaths put it; they lie together at Roselawn Memorial Park.

LOST CREEK TOWNSHIP, 1841 TO 1957

Jessie Ethel Hults: the Hults farm and the Eversoles of Lost Creek

Michael's grandmother Jessie Ethel Hults was born on 10 June 1898 in Vigo County, on her father's farm in Lost Creek Township east of Terre Haute. The census of 1900 caught the household with the name spelled as the enumerator heard it, 'Gerris Hultz': Jennis Hubble Hults, 34, a farmer on his own mortgaged land, born in Vigo County in November 1865; his wife Dora, 35; Jessie, 1; her brother Leland, born that May; and two boys of 8 and 7, Floyd and Ernest, Jennis's sons by his first wife, Mattie Carrico. By 1910 the family had crossed the county line to Lewis Township in Clay County, and Jessie's marriage record of 1917 names her parents as James Hults and Dora Eversole, James being the clerk's best guess at a name nobody could spell. Her death certificate in 1991 has it 'Jennus.'

The Hults and Eversole lines are the oldest Vigo County lines on this page. Jennis's father, Joseph Bound Hults, was born in Butler



Jessie E. Smith, 1898 to 1991, at Roselawn Memorial Park. Photograph from Find a Grave.

County, Ohio, on 27 May 1830, the son of David Hults and Mary Bound, farmed in Clark County, Ohio, in 1860, and had settled in Riley Township, Vigo County, by 1870, where he died on 5 June 1904. Dora's father, Christopher Miller Eversole, born in Fairfield County, Ohio, on 9 July 1814 to Peter Eversole and Elizabeth Miller, married Nancy Ann Latta in Vigo County on 4 November 1841 and farmed at Lost Creek and Riley for forty years until his death on 6 June 1881; Eversole is the Ohio spelling of Ebersol, a name from the Pennsylvania German country. Emma Dora, born on 11 November 1864, was one of their youngest children. Her marriage to Jennis did not last: he married again in June 1922, and Dora died on 23 June 1928, at 63, and was buried at Mount Pleasant Cemetery in Terre Haute under a stone with two crosses and the line 'The cross leads generations on.' Jennis outlived her by nearly thirty years and died in Terre Haute on 12 February 1957, at 91.

KENTUCKY, KANSAS AND THE WABASH, 1811 TO 1950

Garrett and Sarah Smith: Bracken County Smiths and Larue County Killens



Garrett Smith, 1873 to 1950, at Oak Hill Cemetery, Riley, Vigo County, beside Sarah. Photograph from Find a Grave.

The Smith name comes down to Michael from Kentucky. Abraham Smith married Sarah McKinley in Bracken County, on the Ohio River upstream from Cincinnati, on 26 November 1811, and their son Robert McKinley Smith, born there on 29 June 1833, carried his mother's name as his middle name the way Michael carries his. Robert married Julia Ann Reagan, born 26 April 1831, a daughter of William Reagan and Sarah Adaline Collins, and raised a large family in Indiana: William Allen in 1852, Fannie in 1857, Samuel in 1858, Milton in 1863, Patsy in 1867, Garrett on 10 August 1873 and Thomas in 1875. The 1880 census has them in Wildcat Township, Tipton County, north of Indianapolis. Then the family went to Kansas, where Julia died in 1902 and Robert on 10 April 1914 in Montgomery County, and where Fannie, William and Thomas all died too; Garrett was the son who came back to Indiana. His Find a Grave memorial, indeed, gives his birthplace as Kansas, but the census takers of 1900, 1910 and 1930 all had it from him as Indiana.

Garrett R. Smith, 'Codge' to the people who knew him, married Sarah Elizabeth Killen in Vigo County on 21 August 1892, when he was nineteen and she seventeen. She had been born on 16 January 1875 in Larue County, Kentucky, Abraham Lincoln's birth county,

the daughter of Christopher Columbus Killen, born in Kentucky in August 1853, and Nancy Ann DeSpain, born 12 August 1854 in Larue County to James Logan DeSpain and Sarah Ann Oaks, who had married on 5 March 1874. The Killens were at Otter Creek in Larue County in 1880 and in Indiana by the time Sarah married; her father, remarried, farmed in Posey Township, Clay County, in 1900, lived in Terre Haute in 1910 and died at Staunton, Clay County, on 14 September 1940, at 87. Sarah's brothers and sisters were Anna Margaret Timberman, Edward, John, Rebecca Modesitt and Semon.

Garrett and Sarah had six children on the rented farms of Honey Creek and Riley: Robert Wayne in April 1893, Pearl Ruby in November 1894, Mabel Marie in 1897, Hazel Irene in 1899, Esther Josephine in 1901 and Lida in 1904, who died as a girl. In 1900 Garrett was a farm laborer who had been out of work six months of the year. Sarah died on 15 October 1923, at 48, at Wabash Township in Clark County, Illinois, across the river from Terre Haute, and was brought home to Oak Hill Cemetery at Riley; the Tribune noticed her death on 16 October. Garrett lived on as a widower for twenty-seven years, a 'servant to the Boase family' in Honey Creek Township in 1930 in the census taker's phrase, a hired man in his fifties, and at Lost Creek in 1935 and 1940. He died in Terre Haute on 21 November 1950, at 77, when his great-grandson Michael was not quite a year old, and was buried beside Sarah under a matching pink granite stone.

TERRE HAUTE TO SANTA CLARA, 1961 TO 2012

Mark Avenue and the rocket plant

What the directories only hint at, Michael has since set down himself, in the memoir he wrote with Branding by Books between 2024 and 2026, and from here to the end of his own chapters this page follows his account. In Terre Haute Ralph and Patricia ran the Ralph Smith Insurance Agency, named for him, with Patricia keeping the office, while Ralph worked full time at Commercial Solvents, where he had started on the labor crew the men called the barrel gang and worked his way up to the laboratory. Their five children were Michael, the eldest; his brothers Ralph Wayne, David and Thomas; and the youngest, Patricia Jean, Patty, born in 1961, whose care as a baby sent the family to specialists in Chicago and from there to Stanford. In 1963 the Smiths drove west for three



The 1st Cavalry Division on review in Tokyo, 12 May 1946, during Ambassador Edwin Pauley's reparations mission, six months before Ralph's discharge. U.S. Army Signal Corps photograph, Harry S. Truman Library, National Archives.

weeks to see Stanford and find her a doctor, staying with Michael's Aunt Annabelle, and Ralph looked for work while they were there; then they sold the agency, auctioned what they could not carry, and moved to Santa Clara for good, where Ralph was hired by the United Technology Center to work on rocket fuel. Michael was thirteen. The California directories pick the family up in San Jose in 1964 and, from 1969, at 2961 Mark Avenue in Santa Clara, Ralph a technician; the same address and the same trade are in the 1974 directory, and it was the house Michael's brothers and sister grew up in. The United Technology Center at Sunnyvale was the rocket-motor division of United Aircraft, opened in 1959 to build the big segmented solid-fuel boosters of the Titan III, the rockets that put the Air Force's satellites into orbit, with its test stands in the hills of the Coyote Valley south of San Jose; Michael remembers his father's rocket-propellant demonstrations for the children. Ralph retired from United Technologies in 1982, after the Sunnyvale plant had been his working life for the better part of twenty years.

Patricia Bauer Smith died in Santa Clara on 12 July 2002, at 74, after fifty-four years of marriage. What Ralph did next is the coda to his 1945 wedding. Florence Jane Francis, whom he had married on a wartime furlough at eighteen and lost, had married Richard Fields in 1949 and been widowed in 1999; on 18 August 2005, in Vigo County, Ralph Warren Smith, 79, married Florence Jane Fields. She died at Carmel, Indiana, on 8 April 2006, seven months later, and his obituary would count her as his 'wife of seven months.' He went home to Terre Haute for good. Ralph W. Smith died at his home at Westminster Village, 1120 East Davis Drive, Terre Haute, on Tuesday, 7 February 2012, at 85. The Tribune-Star's obituary named his daughter Patricia Jean of San Jose; his sons Michael B. of San Mateo and wife Betty, Thomas E. of San Jose and wife Kristy, David A. of Livermore and wife Kathy, and Ralph Wayne of Alpharetta, Georgia, and wife Mary; his brother Paul and wife Yoshiko; and eleven grandchildren, among them 'Jason Goodwin and wife Petra of California, Robert Goodwin and wife Grace of Texas,' 'Dawn Goodwin of Pacifica' and 'Michelle Lewis and husband Tom of San Mateo.' After a visitation at DeBaun Springhill Chapel in Terre Haute on 11 February, his funeral was held in California on Friday, 17 February 2012, in St. Clare Chapel at Santa Clara Mission Cemetery, 490 Lincoln Street, and he was buried there. Patricia's grave is not recorded in any index online; the family will know whether it is beside his.

WILCOX HIGH SCHOOL TO LZ ENGLISH, 1963 TO 1971

Sky Soldier: a sergeant of the 173d Airborne Brigade

He had been a Catholic-school boy in Terre Haute, and California, he writes, was faster, dearer and more various than Indiana: the pear orchards were coming out for subdivisions, and the Bayshore Freeway was still two lanes each way. He started at Wilcox High School in Santa Clara, and at thirteen and fourteen he was up before five on weekend mornings hawking fruit for an Italian produce stand at the San Jose Flea Market, his father dropping him off, to pay for the clothes a California school expected. On 2 January 1968, at eighteen, he left for the Army from the Greyhound station, his father there to see him off. He had enlisted for the Army's air-defence radar school, with a hope of Germany, where he understood his grandfather Bauer to have been born. Basic training was at Fort Lewis, Washington, in a January colder than any he had known in Terre Haute; then the radar school at Fort Bliss, Texas; then, having volunteered for the airborne, infantry training at Fort Polk, Louisiana, survival training in the Louisiana swamps, three weeks of jump school at Fort Benning, Georgia, and the non-commissioned officers' course that made him a sergeant, the rank the family remembers his father and grandfather holding (the records found so far have both as privates, and the discharge papers that would settle it are still to be found). His first posting as a sergeant was Fort Dix, New Jersey, as a drill sergeant, putting recruits through the training he had just come through himself. Before he shipped out his parents took him to Sunset Beach in their small camper, and his father taught him what he had learned in the Philippines: to read a hillside from the top, and where an ambush is laid.

He flew out by way of Okinawa, came down into Cam Ranh Bay in a steep evasive descent, and within days had his orders for Landing Zone English, the base of the 173d Airborne Brigade in Binh Dinh province, fifty-odd miles north of Qui Nhon, outside the off-limits village of Bong Son. The 173d, the Sky Soldiers, had been the first Army ground combat unit sent to Vietnam, in 1965, and had made the war's only combat parachute jump, in 1967; by 1970 it was fighting the long, small war of the coastal valleys, which was no less dangerous for being small. Michael was a squad leader, a sergeant with his own squad in a rifle company of about two hundred men, responsible, among everything else, for seeing that every one of them swallowed his malaria pill each day. He spent his twenty-first birthday, 2 December 1970, bivouacked where two rivers meet in the valley the soldiers called VC Valley, a long way from home and



Men of the 2nd Battalion, 503rd Infantry, 173d Airborne Brigade, on a search and clear mission 50 kilometres northwest of Bong Son, Binh Dinh province, 29 March 1970, watching a UH-1D come in with the C-rations another helicopter had to leave behind: Michael's brigade, in his year, on his kind of mission. U.S. Army photograph by SP4 Paradis, 111-CCV-637-CC67687, National Archives.

without a cake, at the halfway point of his tour. The worst night had come two months before. In October 1970 his squad fought a North Vietnamese Army unit through the night, with helicopter gunships called in; a grenade went off close by and a fragment of it lodged beside his left eye, where it still is, the doctors having judged it safer left alone. He spent three days in the hospital, and for that night he was awarded the Bronze Star and the Purple Heart, which he counts, in his book, as his squad's as much as his own.

Afterwards the brigade moved him to its public information office at headquarters, under Staff Sergeant Lorenzo Santini, who took him up in a Huey the first afternoon to a company that had just fought off a regiment, and set about teaching him photography and photojournalism. One of his stories, a soldier's own account of what he had been through, was printed on the front page of Stars and Stripes. Then came the rockets: on a patrol he found wooden crates of rockets stencilled in Russian, proof of where the other side's weapons were coming from; a general flew out by helicopter to see them, and Michael's photograph of the general with the Russian-marked rockets went out through the brigade's own paper to UPI and AP, ran in newspapers around the world and on the front of Stars and Stripes again, over the credit 'Photo by Mike Smith.' He came home in 1971 by way of Seattle and San Jose, and had the taxi from the Greyhound station drop him at the corner of his parents' street so that he could walk the last of the way with his duffel bag on his shoulder. His mother fainted at the sight of him. His sister Patty, who could not manage 'Michael,' called him CoCo.

SAN JOSE AND SAN MATEO, 1971 TO TODAY

Michael, Betty and the five

He came back to the GI Bill and the trades. He studied at West Valley College in Saratoga and went on to San Jose State as a junior in photojournalism, working meanwhile as a laborer for Barnhart Construction on the building of Santa Teresa High School, where his brother Tom already worked and the foremen were Oklahoma Dust Bowl families who knew everything about building; the trade held him, and he became a journeyman carpenter. Three years on the construction of the SamTrans South Base, the bus yard beside the San Carlos airport, ended with the San Mateo County Transit District hiring him, and he stayed more than twenty years, rising to Superintendent of Facilities, with the headquarters and the South Base he had helped build under his charge; a transit-association

article on his career noted the automatic earthquake gas shut-off he developed for the district's buildings, which proved itself in the Loma Prieta earthquake of 1989, and the hazardous-waste cleanup trailer he designed. He has had his own company since 1990: EBR Services, Everything But Roofing, which he ran on evenings and weekends through his SamTrans years and full time after he retired, and which a son and a nephew are now being trained to take on.

It was at SamTrans that he met Betty. He was single and working through breakfast, and when he came in to turn in purchase orders Betty Goodwin, in the purchasing department, would make him sit down and eat half of her sandwich, because nobody, she said, should go that long without eating. 'It had been a while since someone cared for me like that,' he writes. 'I ended up marrying her.' She was Elizabeth Anne Goodwin, born in San Mateo County on 29 May 1951, the daughter of Robert Charles Goodwin and Peggy Lou Miller, whose own family's story fills the companion pages of this site, and she had three children, Dawn, Jason and Robert. Michael bought a house a block and a half from her father's, and he and Robert Goodwin became close. They were married in 1990, driving up to Lake Tahoe with Betty's closest friends for the ceremony on the North Shore, on the Nevada side, where there was no waiting period, and the reception on the South Shore in California. Their daughter Michelle, born in the season of the 1989 earthquake, was nicknamed Richter for it. The same year he started EBR Services and named it for Betty, and the two of them paid off three mortgages with four children at the table, Jason, he notes, eating like a horse; the house rule at Taco Bell was two items each and nothing premium. They made their home in San Mateo, in a house built in 1907, for more than thirty years, and the two names sit side by side in the printed record: 'Betty Smith of San Mateo' in her stepfather's obituary of 2005, and 'Michael B. of San Mateo and wife Betty' in Ralph's of 2012.

Michael's five children are Michael Jr., his son from an earlier relationship, and Jason, Robert, Dawn and Michelle, whom he raised with Betty; Robert is Bobby, Grace's husband, for whom the family page on this site was made. Michael Jr. carried the family's line of service into a fourth generation, in the Marine Corps, which his father calls a betrayal of three generations of the Army and forgives: he trained as a heavy equipment mechanic at Camp Pendleton, deployed to Iraq in April 2003 and again in 2008, and made sergeant. He went out from the depot at Lathrop, California, and came home to it behind a police escort with an honor guard waiting, the homecoming his father had not had; the family's teasing about the Marines, Michael writes, was how they carried the worry. He later moved to Minnesota, where Ralph's obituary found him in

2012. The grandchildren came in turn: Braden, Michael Jr.'s son, born in Concord in 2006, the first; Maverick, Dawn's son, born in 2013, who grew up in the San Mateo house and said 'grandad' before he said 'mommy'; and Lilly, Robert and Grace's daughter, Elizabeth Lenora, who carries Betty's name, born in Burlingame in 2017, whose bedroom in the 1907 house Michael remodelled with Robert and his brother Tom before she arrived, wainscoting against pink and grey walls and a chandelier that took two men to hang.

Betty died on 13 February 2021, the day before Valentine's Day, in the pandemic year, when for months the family could not be with her. She had beaten cancer; it was pneumonia, in her weakened state, that took her, with Robert and Dawn beside her. The day after Valentine's Day the postman brought her Valentine's card, returned by the post office. The Skylawn Funeral Home notice in San Mateo that the first version of this page could only put as a question was hers. The years since are in his book, which is his to tell.

UNFINISHED

What is still to be found

The 1948 wedding was surely written up in the Tribune's society pages, with the church, the attendants and the bride's dress, and that is a search away. Anton Bauer's baptism is in the Stollhofen parish register on Matricula Online, Taufbuch 01/08, the 1881 to 1907 book, and a reader of the old German hand will find there his godparents, the house number at Frauendorf and his grandparents' names, one generation further back than this page reaches. The passenger list of his crossing in 1901 or 1902 has not been identified, and the Milwaukee naturalization of 1906 needs settling one way or the other. Patricia's obituary of July 2002 has not been located in the San Jose Mercury News. Ralph's Army papers, his separation record and the 1st Cavalry Division's rosters would say where he was between Luzon and Tokyo, and whether the family's memory of a sergeant's stripes is right; his Official Military Personnel File can be requested from the National Personnel Records Center in St. Louis, and Pearl's, which would give his unit in France, likewise. Emma Alice Winters Beam's death has not been found, and Nancy Ann DeSpain's is given two ways by two sources. Michael's own chapters now rest on his memoir, and what would add most to them is a photograph: the Wilcox High School yearbooks of 1965 to 1968 should carry his class picture, and the family's albums will have the jump wings and the sergeant's stripes. The Army's

record of his Bronze Star and Purple Heart is in his own file at St. Louis, which only he can request. The page is built so that all of it can be added.

AHNENTAFEL

The line, in brief

Numbered the genealogists' way: a father is twice his child's number, a mother twice plus one. Entries marked 'trees' rest on other researchers' family trees and have not yet been checked against an original record.

1 **Michael Bauer Smith Sr.**, 2 Dec 1949, St. Anthony's Hospital, Terre Haute; Santa Clara from 1963; Sgt, 173d Airborne Brigade, Vietnam 1970 to 1971; SamTrans; San Mateo

2 **Ralph Warren Smith**, 28 May 1926 Honey Creek Twp, Vigo Co., Indiana; d. 7 Feb 2012 Terre Haute; buried Santa Clara Mission Cemetery

3 **Patricia Antoinette Bauer**, 1 Mar 1928 Terre Haute; d. 12 Jul 2002 Santa Clara, California

4 **Pearl Ruby Smith**, 8 Nov 1894 Vigo Co.; Pvt, US Army 1917 to 1919; coal miner 1926; d. 15 Mar 1978 Terre Haute; Roselawn Memorial Park

5 **Jessie Ethel Hults**, 10 Jun 1898 Lost Creek Twp, Vigo Co.; d. 1 Sep 1991 Terre Haute; Roselawn

6 **Anton P. Bauer**, 7 May 1883 Frauendorf, Lower Austria; to America 1901; upholsterer; d. 2 Mar 1977 Terre Haute; Calvary Cemetery

7 **Ida Belle (Lillian) Beam**, 6 Aug 1889 Indiana; d. 25 Mar 1973 Terre Haute; Calvary Cemetery

8 **Garrett R. Smith**, 10 Aug 1873 Indiana (Tipton Co. in 1880); d. 21 Nov 1950 Terre Haute; Oak Hill Cemetery, Riley

9 **Sarah Elizabeth Killen**, 16 Jan 1875 Larue Co., Kentucky; d. 15 Oct 1923 Wabash Twp, Clark Co., Illinois; Oak Hill, Riley

10 **Jennis Hubble Hults**, 26 Nov 1865 Vigo Co.; d. 12 Feb 1957 Terre Haute

11 **Emma Dora Eversole**, 11 Nov 1864 Vigo Co.; d. 23 Jun 1928; Mount Pleasant Cemetery, Terre Haute

12 **Florian Bauer**, 1844, Austria; d. 1927 Frauendorf (cousins' trees)

13 **Barbara Crites**, 1850, Austria; d. 1935 Frauendorf (cousins' trees; spelling from Anton's death certificate)

14	**Jacob Beam**, Nov 1851 Indiana; wagon maker, Terre Haute; death not found
15	**Emma Alice Winters**, married 12 Nov 1888 Vigo Co.; death not found
16	**Robert McKinley Smith**, 29 Jun 1833 Bracken Co., Kentucky; d. 10 Apr 1914 Montgomery Co., Kansas (trees)
17	**Julia Ann (Morris) Reagan**, 26 Apr 1831; d. 16 Nov 1902 Kansas (trees)
18	**Christopher Columbus Killen**, Aug 1853 Kentucky; d. 14 Sep 1940 Staunton, Clay Co., Indiana
19	**Nancy Ann DeSpain**, 12 Aug 1854 Larue Co., Kentucky; death uncertain
20	**Joseph Bound Hults**, 27 May 1830 Butler Co., Ohio; d. 5 Jun 1904 Riley Twp, Vigo Co.
21	**Emmaline Catterlin**, (trees)
22	**Christopher Miller Eversole**, 9 Jul 1814 Fairfield Co., Ohio; d. 6 Jun 1881 Vigo Co.
23	**Nancy Ann (McCroskey) Latta**, married 4 Nov 1841 Vigo Co.
32, 33	**Abraham Smith and Sarah McKinley**, married 26 Nov 1811 Bracken Co., Kentucky
34, 35	**William Reagan and Sarah Adaline Collins**, (trees)
38, 39	**James Logan DeSpain and Sarah Ann Oaks**, Larue Co., Kentucky (trees)
40, 41	**David Hults and Mary Bound**, Ohio (trees)
44, 45	**Peter Eversole and Elizabeth (Betsy) Miller**, Ohio (trees)

1811 TO 2021

Timeline

1811	Abraham Smith marries Sarah McKinley in Bracken County, Kentucky, 26 November
1814	Christopher Miller Eversole born in Fairfield County, Ohio, 9 July
1830	Joseph Bound Hults born in Butler County, Ohio, 27 May
1833	Robert McKinley Smith born in Bracken County, Kentucky, 29 June
1841	Christopher Eversole marries Nancy Ann Latta in Vigo County, 4 November
1844	Florian Bauer born, Lower Austria
1851	Jacob Beam born in Indiana, November
1853	Christopher Columbus Killen born in Kentucky, 8 August

1864	Emma Dora Eversole born in Vigo County, 11 November
1865	Jennis Hubble Hults born in Vigo County, 26 November
1873	Garrett R. Smith born in Indiana, 10 August
1874	Christopher Killen marries Nancy Ann DeSpain in Larue County, Kentucky, 5 March
1875	Sarah Elizabeth Killen born in Larue County, Kentucky, 16 January
1883	Anton Bauer born at Frauendorf, parish of Stollhofen, Lower Austria, 7 May
1888	Jacob Beam marries Emma Alice Winters in Vigo County, 12 November
1889	Ida Belle Beam born in Indiana, 6 August
1892	Garrett Smith, 19, marries Sarah Killen, 17, in Vigo County, 21 August
1894	Pearl Ruby Smith born in Vigo County, 8 November
1898	Jessie Ethel Hults born in Lost Creek Township, Vigo County, 10 June
1901	Anton Bauer emigrates from Austria, at eighteen
1908	Anton Bauer marries Ida Belle Beam in Vigo County, 14 May; eleven children follow at 1100 Poplar Street
1917	Pearl Smith registers for the draft, 5 June; enters the Army, 21 September; the 84th Division reviewed at Camp Zachary Taylor, 10 November; Pearl marries Jessie Hults in Clark County, Indiana, 24 November
1918	Anton Bauer, upholsterer, 1100 Poplar Street, registers for the draft as a declarant alien, 12 September
1919	Pearl's first child, Jessie Maxine, born 2 January; Pearl discharged, 18 April
1923	Sarah Killen Smith dies at Wabash Township, Clark County, Illinois, 15 October; buried at Oak Hill, Riley
1926	Ralph Warren Smith born in Honey Creek Township, 28 May, to Pearl, a coal miner, and Jessie
1928	Patricia Antoinette Bauer born in Terre Haute, 1 March; Dora Eversole Hults dies, 23 June
1930	Census: the Smiths on Spring Hill Road, Honey Creek; the Bauers, ten children, at 1100 Poplar Street
1944	Ralph registers for the draft, 15 May; inducted at Indianapolis, 9 September; his parents divorce in November
1945	Ralph, 18, marries Florence Jane Francis on furlough, 26 January; the 1st Cavalry Division takes Manila, 3 February, and enters Tokyo, 8 September; Pearl and Jessie remarry each other, 8 November

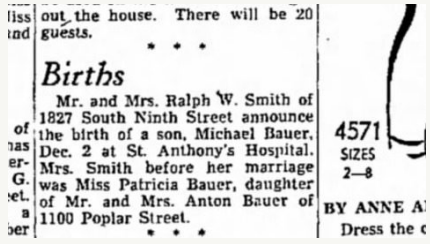
1946	The 1st Cavalry Division reviewed in Tokyo, 12 May; Ralph discharged from the Army, 22 November
1948	Ralph marries Patricia Bauer on his twenty-second birthday, 28 May, on a Clay County license; registers for the peacetime draft as a Commercial Solvents watchman, 8 September
1949	Michael Bauer Smith born at St. Anthony's Hospital, Terre Haute, 2 December; announced in the Star, 10 December
1950	Census, 3 April: Ralph, 23, laboratory technician, Patricia, 22, and Michael, 0, upstairs at 43 South 15th Street, upstairs from Patricia's brother Anton Bauer Jr. and his family; Garrett Smith dies, 21 November
1961	Patricia Jean, Patty, the youngest of Ralph and Patricia's five, born
1963	The Smiths sell the Ralph Smith Insurance Agency and move from Terre Haute to Santa Clara for Patty's care at Stanford; Ralph hired by the United Technology Center; Michael, 13, starts at Wilcox High School
1954	Anton Bauer's shop advertises in the Tribune: 'Upholstering, refinishing and repairs, 1100 Poplar'
1957	Jennis Hults dies in Terre Haute, 12 February
1969	Ralph, technician, at 2961 Mark Avenue, Santa Clara, working for United Technology Center, Sunnyvale
1970	Michael a squad leader with the 173d Airborne Brigade at LZ English, Binh Dinh province; wounded in October, Bronze Star and Purple Heart; his 21st birthday in the field, 2 December
1971	Michael a combat correspondent and photographer in the brigade's public information office; home to Santa Clara; Anton Bauer's 88th birthday noticed in the Tribune, 10 May
1973	Ida Belle Bauer dies at home, 2800 Kussner Street, Terre Haute, 25 March; Mass at St. Patrick's, 28 March; buried at Calvary
1977	Anton Bauer dies in Terre Haute, 93, 2 March
1978	Pearl Smith dies in Terre Haute, 83, 15 March; buried at Roselawn under a government marker
1982	Ralph retires from United Technologies, Sunnyvale
1990	Michael marries Betty Goodwin at Lake Tahoe; founds EBR Services and names it for her
1991	Jessie Hults Smith dies in Terre Haute, 93, 1 September
2002	Patricia Bauer Smith dies in Santa Clara, 12 July, after 54 years of marriage

2003	Michael Jr., U.S. Marine Corps, deploys to Iraq in April, and again in 2008
2005	Ralph, 79, marries Florence Fields, his wife of 1945, in Vigo County, 18 August; she dies 8 April 2006
2006	Braden, the first grandchild, born in Concord; Maverick follows in 2013 and Lilly in 2017
2012	Ralph Warren Smith dies at Westminster Village, Terre Haute, 7 February; funeral at St. Clare Chapel, Santa Clara Mission Cemetery, 17 February
2021	Betty Goodwin Smith dies in San Mateo, 13 February

DOCUMENTS AND PHOTOGRAPHS

The paper trail

Draft cards, a birth certificate, the census sheet with Michael on it, the newspaper notices and the stones, with the Army's own photographs of the division Ralph served in and the camp Pearl trained at.



out the house. There will be 20 guests.

* * *

Births

Mr. and Mrs. Ralph W. Smith of 1827 South Ninth Street announce the birth of a son, Michael Bauer, Dec. 2 at St. Anthony's Hospital. Mrs. Smith before her marriage was Miss Patricia Bauer, daughter of Mr. and Mrs. Anton Bauer of 1100 Poplar Street.

* * *

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SIZES
2—8

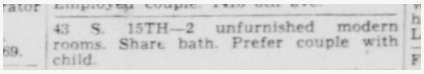
BY ANNE A

Dress the

The Terre Haute Star, 10 December 1949, page 5: the birth of Michael Bauer Smith, 2 December, at St. Anthony's Hospital. Newspapers.com.

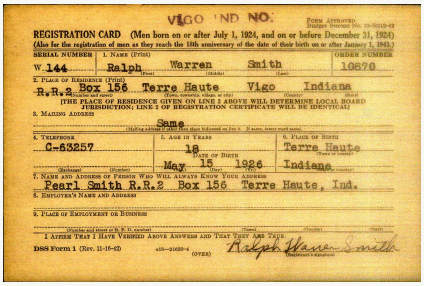


The 1950 census, Terre Haute, sheet begun 3 April 1950: at '43, back,' South 15th Street, Anton J. Bauer Jr., 28, upholsterer, his wife Virginia, 24, who operated a bottling machine at a wholesale distillery, and their two small children; at '43, upstairs,' Ralph W. Smith, 23, laboratory technician, Patricia A., 22, and 'Michael B., son,' born 'Dec.' National Archives, via Ancestry.



43 S. 15TH—2 unfurnished modern rooms. Share bath. Prefer couple with child.

The Terre Haute Tribune, Sunday, 4 September 1949, page 30, Apartments for Rent: '43 S. 15th. 2 unfurnished modern rooms. Share bath. Prefer couple with child.' Newspapers.com.



VIGO IND NO.

REGISTRATION CARD (Men born on or after July 1, 1924, and on or before December 31, 1924)
(Also for the registration of men as they reach the 18th anniversary of the date of their birth on or after January 1, 1943.)

SERIAL NUMBER: W 144 | 1. NAME (Print): Ralph (First) Warren (Middle) Smith (Last) | ORDER NUMBER: 10670

2. PLACE OF RESIDENCE (Print): R.R.2 Box 156 Terre Haute (Street and number, or rural) Vigo (County) Indiana (State)
[THE PLACE OF RESIDENCE GIVEN ON LINE 2 ABOVE WILL DETERMINE LOCAL BOARD JURISDICTION; LINE 2 OF REGISTRATION CERTIFICATE WILL BE IDENTICAL]

3. MAILING ADDRESS: Same (Mailing address if other than that given in answer to No. 2. If same, insert word "same")

4. TELEPHONE: C-63257 (Number) | 5. AGE IN YEARS: 18 | DATE OF BIRTH: May 15 1926 (Month) (Day) (Year) | 6. PLACE OF BIRTH: Terre Haute (City or town) Indiana (State or country)

7. NAME AND ADDRESS OF PERSON WHO WILL ALWAYS KNOW YOUR ADDRESS: Pearl Smith R.R.2 Box 156 Terre Haute, Ind.

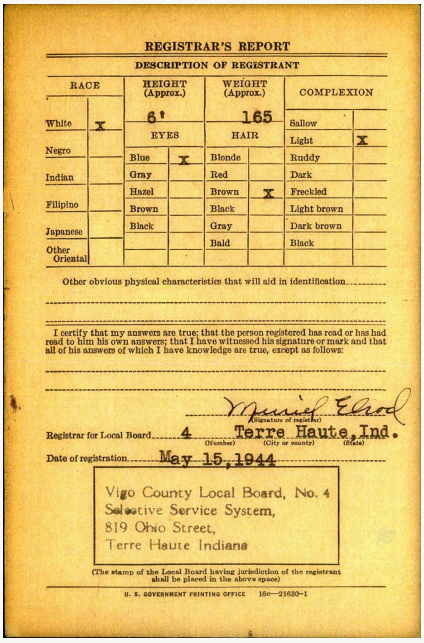
8. EMPLOYER'S NAME AND ADDRESS

9. PLACE OF EMPLOYMENT OR BUSINESS (Number and street or R. F. D. number) (Town) (County) (State)

I AFFIRM THAT I HAVE VERIFIED ABOVE ANSWERS AND THAT THEY ARE TRUE. Ralph Warren Smith (Registrant's signature)

DSS Form 1 (Rev. 11-16-42) 459—21630-4 (OVER)

Ralph Warren Smith's draft registration card, 15 May 1944: R.R. 2, Box 156, Terre Haute; born 'May 15, 1926'; next of kin Pearl Smith. National Archives, via Ancestry.



REGISTRAR'S REPORT

DESCRIPTION OF REGISTRANT

RACE		HEIGHT (Approx.)		WEIGHT (Approx.)		COMPLEXION	
White	X	6'		165		Sallow	
Negro		EYES		HAIR		Light	X
Indian		Blue	X	Blonde		Ruddy	
		Gray		Red		Dark	
Filipino		Hazel		Brown	X	Freckled	
		Brown		Black		Light brown	
Japanese		Black		Gray		Dark brown	
Other Oriental				Bald		Black	

Other obvious physical characteristics that will aid in identification

I certify that my answers are true; that the person registered has read or has had read to him his own answers; that I have witnessed his signature or mark and that all of his answers of which I have knowledge are true, except as follows:

Maurice Elrod (Signature of registrar)

Registrar for Local Board 4 (Number) Terre Haute, Ind. (City or county) (State)

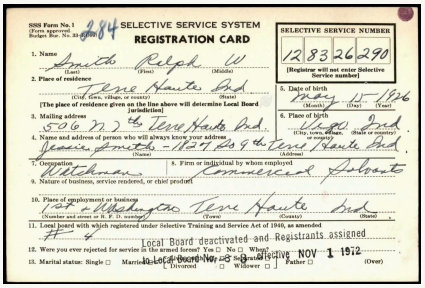
Date of registration May 15, 1944

Vigo County Local Board, No. 4
Selective Service System,
819 Ohio Street,
Terre Haute Indiana

(The stamp of the Local Board having jurisdiction of the registrant shall be placed in the above space)

U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE 16—21630-1

The registrar's report on the back of the card: white, six feet, 165 pounds, blue eyes, brown hair, light complexion; Local Board No. 4, 819 Ohio Street, Terre Haute.

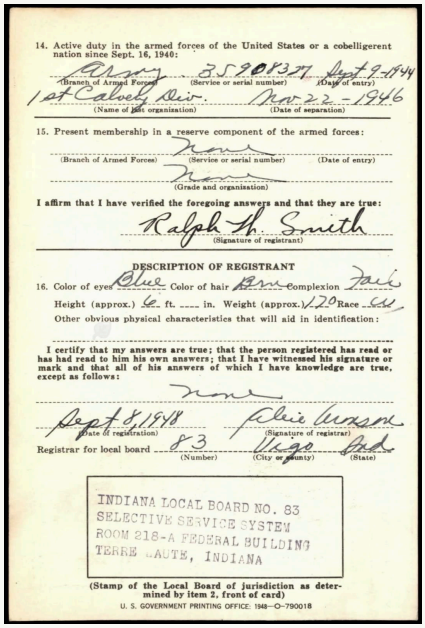


SSS Form No. 1 (Form approved. Budget Bur. No. 33-R010.1) 284
SELECTIVE SERVICE SYSTEM
REGISTRATION CARD

SELECTIVE SERVICE NUMBER: 12 83 26 290 [Registrar will not enter Selective Service number]

1. Name: Smith (Last) Ralph (First) W (Middle)
2. Place of residence: Terre Haute (City, town, village, or county) Ind (State) [The place of residence given on the line above will determine Local Board Jurisdiction]
3. Mailing address: 506 N 7th Terre Haute Ind (Number, street, or R. F. D. number) (Town) (State)
4. Name and address of person who will always know your address: Jessie Smith - 1827 So 9th Terre Haute Ind (Name) (Address)
5. Date of birth: May 15 1926 (Month) (Day) (Year)
6. Place of birth: Ind (City, town, village, or county) (State or country)
7. Occupation: Watchman
8. Firm or individual by whom employed: Commercial Solvents
9. Nature of business, service rendered, or chief product:
10. Place of employment or business: First & Washington Terre Haute Ind (Number and street or R. F. D. number) (Town) (County) (State)
11. Local board with which registered under Selective Training and Service Act of 1940, as amended: 4 Local Board deactivated and Registrants assigned to Local Board No. 2
12. Were you ever rejected for service in the armed forces? Yes ☐ No ☐ When? NOV 1 1972
13. Marital status: Single ☐ Married ☐ Widower ☐ Separated ☐ Divorced ☐ Husband of Woman Registrant ☐ Father ☐ (Over)

Ralph's Selective Service registration card of 8 September 1948, at 506 North 7th Street: watchman, Commercial Solvents, First and Washington; born 'May 15, 1926'; the person who would always know his address, his mother Jessie Smith, 1827 South 9th Street. National Archives at St. Louis, via Fold3.



14. Active duty in the armed forces of the United States or a cobelligerent nation since Sept. 16, 1940:

Army — 35908327 — Sept 9-1944
(Branch of Armed Forces) (Service or serial number) (Date of entry)

1st Calvary Div. — Nov 22 - 1946
(Name of last organization) (Date of separation)

15. Present membership in a reserve component of the armed forces:

None
(Branch of Armed Forces) (Service or serial number) (Date of entry)

None
(Grade and organization)

I affirm that I have verified the foregoing answers and that they are true:

Ralph W. Smith
(Signature of registrant)

DESCRIPTION OF REGISTRANT

16. Color of eyes Blue Color of hair Brn complexion Fair

Height (approx.) 6 ft. ___ in. Weight (approx.) 170 Race Cau

Other obvious physical characteristics that will aid in identification:

I certify that my answers are true; that the person registered has read or has had read to him his own answers; that I have witnessed his signature or mark and that all of his answers of which I have knowledge are true, except as follows:

None

Sept 8 1948 — Alvie Cruson
(Date of registration) (Signature of registrar)

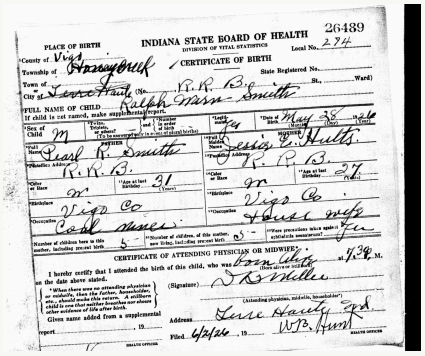
Registrar for local board 83 Vigo Ind
(Number) (City or county) (State)

INDIANA LOCAL BOARD NO. 83
SELECTIVE SERVICE SYSTEM
ROOM 218-A FEDERAL BUILDING
TERRE HAUTE, INDIANA

(Stamp of the Local Board of jurisdiction as determined by item 2, front of card)

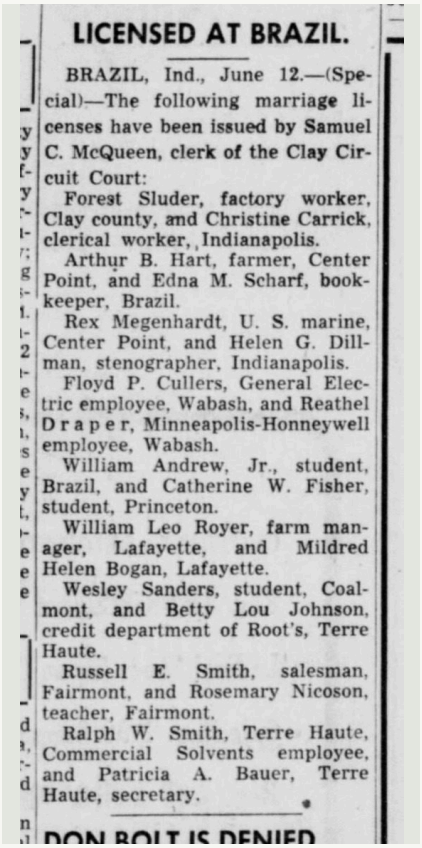
U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE: 1948—O-790018

The back of the 1948 card, in Ralph's hand: 'Army, 35908327, Sept. 9, 1944; 1st Cavalry Div., Nov. 22, 1946'; no reserve membership; blue eyes, brown hair, fair, six feet, 170 pounds; signed 'Ralph W. Smith' and registered 8 September 1948, Vigo County.



PLACE OF BIRTH — INDIANA STATE BOARD OF HEALTH — 26439
DIVISION OF VITAL STATISTICS — Local No. 274
County of Vigo — Township of Honey Creek — CERTIFICATE OF BIRTH
Town of Terre Haute — No. R.R. B.S. — State Registered No.
City of — St., — Ward)
FULL NAME OF CHILD — Ralph Mass Smith
If child is not named, make supplemental report.
Sex of Child M — Color or Race W — Single, Married, Widowed or Divorced (Write) M — Date of Birth (Month) May (Day) 28 (Year) 26
Full Name of Father — Pearl R. Smith — Maiden Name of Mother — Jessie E. Hults
Residence — R.R. B.S. — Residence — R.R. B.S.
Color or Race — W — Age at last Birthday — 31 (Years) — Color or Race — W — Age at last Birthday — 27 (Years)
Birthplace — Vigo Co — Birthplace — Vigo Co.
Occupation — Coal miner — Occupation — House wife
Number of children born to this mother, including present birth — 5 — Number of children, of this mother, now living, including this birth — 3 — Was precedency when again satisfactorily ascertained — Yes
CERTIFICATE OF ATTENDING PHYSICIAN OR MIDWIFE
I hereby certify that I attended the birth of this child, who was born alive at 7:30 P. M. on the date above stated.
(Signature) D R Miller
(Attending physician, midwife, householder)
Address Terre Haute Ind
Filed 6/2/26, 19 — W.P. Hunt — HEALTH OFFICER
Given name added from a supplemental report, 19 — HEALTH OFFICER

Ralph's Indiana birth certificate, 28 May 1926, Honey Creek Township: father Pearl R. Smith, 31, coal miner; mother Jessie E. Hults, 27. Indiana Archives, via Ancestry.



LICENSED AT BRAZIL.

BRAZIL, Ind., June 12.—(Special)—The following marriage licenses have been issued by Samuel C. McQueen, clerk of the Clay Circuit Court:

Forest Sluder, factory worker, Clay county, and Christine Carrick, clerical worker, Indianapolis.

Arthur B. Hart, farmer, Center Point, and Edna M. Scharf, bookkeeper, Brazil.

Rex Megenhardt, U. S. marine, Center Point, and Helen G. Dillman, stenographer, Indianapolis.

Floyd P. Cullers, General Electric employee, Wabash, and Reathel Draper, Minneapolis-Honneywell employee, Wabash.

William Andrew, Jr., student, Brazil, and Catherine W. Fisher, student, Princeton.

William Leo Royer, farm manager, Lafayette, and Mildred Helen Bogan, Lafayette.

Wesley Sanders, student, Coalmont, and Betty Lou Johnson, credit department of Root's, Terre Haute.

Russell E. Smith, salesman, Fairmont, and Rosemary Nicoson, teacher, Fairmont.

Ralph W. Smith, Terre Haute, Commercial Solvents employee, and Patricia A. Bauer, Terre Haute, secretary.

DON BOLT IS DENIED

Terre Haute Tribune, 13 June 1948: 'Ralph W. Smith, Terre Haute, Commercial Solvents employee, and Patricia A. Bauer, Terre Haute, secretary,' among the licenses issued at Brazil. Newspapers.com.



Manila, 23 February 1945: troopers of the 12th Cavalry, 1st Cavalry Division, raise the flag over the recaptured Manila Hotel, General MacArthur in the background. U.S. Army Signal Corps photograph 111-SC-202169, National Archives.



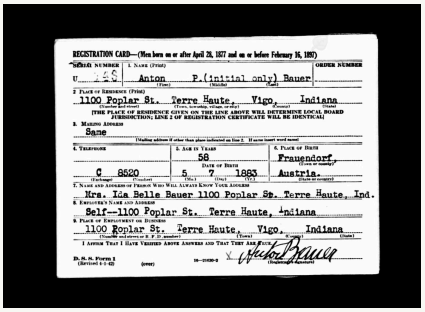
Men of the 1st Cavalry Division guard Japanese prisoners burying the dead at the Santo Tomas camp, Manila, 1945. U.S. Air Force photograph 82271AC, National Archives.



The 1st Cavalry Division on review in Tokyo, 12 May 1946, during the United States reparations mission to Japan; Edwin Pauley, the ambassador on the Allied Reparations Committee, stands at the far right. U.S. Army Signal Corps photograph, Harry S. Truman Library, National Archives, 2009-967.



Ralph Warren Smith, 1926 to 2012, Michael's father. From his Find a Grave memorial, added by Linda Crandall, September 2012.



REGISTRATION CARD—(Men born on or after April 28, 1877 and on or before February 16, 1897)

1. Name (First) Anton P. (initial only) Bauer (Middle) (Last) — Order Number U 1 C 6

2. Place of Residence (Print) 1100 Poplar St. Terre Haute, (Number and street or R. F. D. number) Vigo, (County) Indiana (State)

THE PLACE OF RESIDENCE GIVEN ON THE LINE ABOVE WILL DETERMINE LOCAL BOARD JURISDICTION; LINE 2 OF REGISTRATION CERTIFICATE WILL BE IDENTICAL

3. Mailing Address Same (Nothing additional if same as line 2. If more space is required, write here)

4. Telephone C 8520 (Exchange) (Number)

5. Age in Years 58 — Date of Birth (Month) 5 (Day) 7 (Year) 1883

6. Place of Birth Frauendorf, (Town or county) Austria. (State or country)

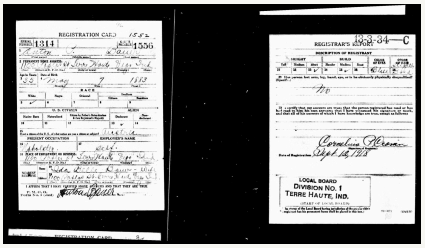
7. Name and Address of Person Who Will Always Know Your Address Mrs. Ida Belle Bauer 1100 Poplar St. Terre Haute, Ind.

8. Employer's Name and Address Self—1100 Poplar St. Terre Haute, Indiana

9. Place of Employment or Business 1100 Poplar St. Terre Haute, (Number and street or R. F. D. number) Vigo, (County) Indiana (State)

I Affirm That I Have Verified Above Answers and That They Are True. Anton P. Bauer (Witness if mark) (Registrant's signature)

D. S. S. Form 1 (Revised 5-1-42) 16-21676-2 (over)



REGISTRATION CARD 1552

1314 1556

REGISTRAR'S STUB 1834—C

DESCRIPTION OF REGISTRANT

RACE: White, Negro, Oriental, American Indian

Age in years: 35

Date of birth: Sept 12 1883

Place of birth: Frauendorf Austria

Citizen or alien: Alien

Name of person who will always know your address: Mrs Ida Belle Bauer

Address of person who will always know your address: 1100 Poplar St Terre Haute Ind

Employer's name and address: Self

Place of employment or business: 1100 Poplar St Terre Haute Ind

Height: Medium

Weight: Medium

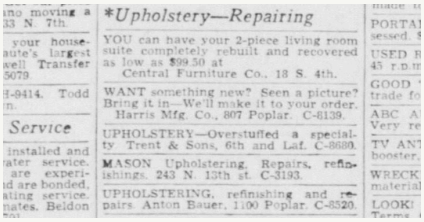
Color of eyes: Blue

Color of hair: Bald

Complexion: Slightly

LOCAL BOARD DIVISION NO. 1 TERRE HAUTE, IND.

Anton P. Bauer's draft registration card of 12 September 1918, Terre Haute: 35, an upholsterer working for himself at 1100 Poplar Street, a declarant alien of Austria, nearest relative Ida Belle Bauer, wife; short, medium build, blue eyes, 'slightly bald.' National Archives, via Ancestry.



*Upholstery—Repairing

YOU can have your 2-piece living room suite completely rebuilt and recovered as low as $99.50 at Central Furniture Co., 18 S. 4th.

WANT something new? Seen a picture? Bring it in—We'll make it to your order. Harris Mfg. Co., 807 Poplar. C-8139.

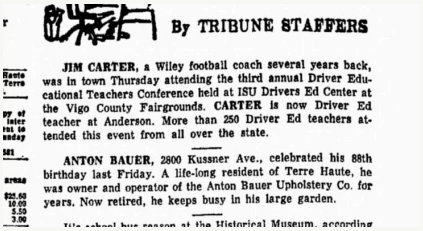
UPHOLSTERY—Overstuffed a specialty. Trent & Sons, 6th and Laf. C-8680.

MASON Upholstering. Repairs, refinishings. 243 N. 13th st. C-3193.

UPHOLSTERING, refinishing and repairs. Anton Bauer, 1100 Poplar. C-8520.

Service

Terre Haute Tribune, 30 January 1954, service directory: 'Upholstering, refinishing and repairs. Anton Bauer, 1100 Poplar. C-8520.' Newspapers.com.

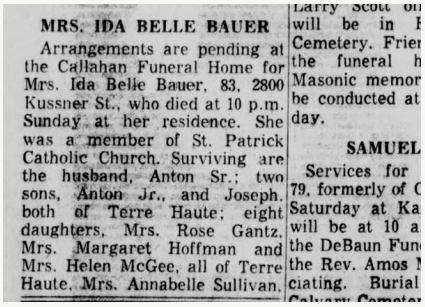


By TRIBUNE STAFFERS

JIM CARTER, a Wiley football coach several years back, was in town Thursday attending the third annual Driver Educational Teachers Conference held at ISU Drivers Ed Center at the Vigo County Fairgrounds. **CARTER** is now Driver Ed teacher at Anderson. More than 250 Driver Ed teachers attended this event from all over the state.

ANTON BAUER, 2800 Kussner Ave., celebrated his 88th birthday last Friday. A life-long resident of Terre Haute, he was owner and operator of the Anton Bauer Upholstery Co. for years. Now retired, he keeps busy in his large garden.

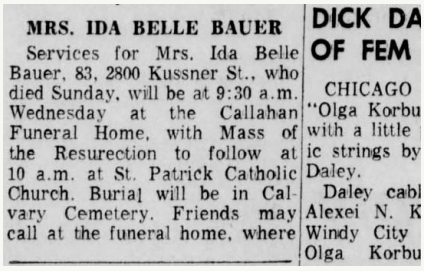
Terre Haute Tribune, 10 May 1971, the 'Nosey News Hawk' column: Anton Bauer's 88th birthday. Newspapers.com.



MRS. IDA BELLE BAUER

Arrangements are pending at the Callahan Funeral Home for Mrs. Ida Belle Bauer, 83, 2800 Kussner St., who died at 10 p.m. Sunday at her residence. She was a member of St. Patrick Catholic Church. Surviving are the husband, Anton Sr.; two sons, Anton Jr., and Joseph, both of Terre Haute; eight daughters, Mrs. Rose Gantz, Mrs. Margaret Hoffman and Mrs. Helen McGee, all of Terre Haute, Mrs. Annabelle Sullivan,

Terre Haute Tribune, 26 March 1973: Mrs. Ida Belle Bauer, 83, of 2800 Kussner Street. Newspapers.com.



MRS. IDA BELLE BAUER

Services for Mrs. Ida Belle Bauer, 83, 2800 Kussner St., who died Sunday, will be at 9:30 a.m. Wednesday at the Callahan Funeral Home, with Mass of the Resurection to follow at 10 a.m. at St. Patrick Catholic Church. Burial will be in Calvary Cemetery. Friends may call at the funeral home, where

DICK DA OF FEM

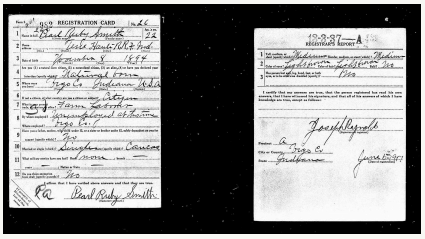
CHICAGO "Olga Korbu with a little ic strings by Daley.

Daley cabl Alexei N. K Windy City Olga Korbu

Terre Haute Tribune, 27 March 1973: the funeral notice, Callahan Funeral Home, Mass of the Resurrection at St. Patrick's, burial at Calvary. Newspapers.com.



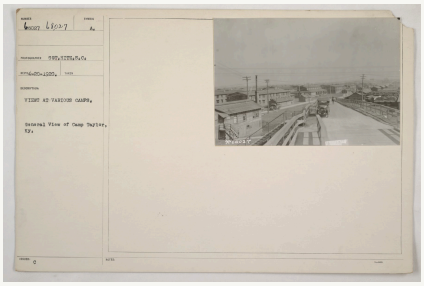
Anton Sr. and Ida Belle Bauer, Calvary Cemetery, Terre Haute, Section 8. Find a Grave, Wabash Valley Genealogy Society.



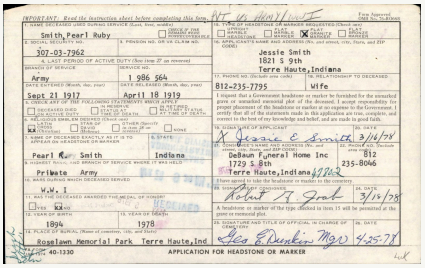
Pearl Ruby Smith's draft registration card, 5 June 1917, Vigo County. National Archives, via Ancestry.



'Review of the 84th Division at Camp Zachary Taylor, November 10th 1917,' a panorama by the Royal Photo Co. of Louisville, two weeks before Pearl Smith's wedding across the river at Jeffersonville. National Archives, 165-PP-9-5.



'General View of Camp Taylor, Ky.,' the cantonment where most of Indiana's 1917 draftees trained. U.S. Army Signal Corps photograph 111-SC-68027 by Sgt. Hitz, National Archives.



Smith, Pearl Ruby

307-03-7962

Army

1 986 564

Sept 21 1917

April 18 1919

Private Army

Pearl R. Smith Indiana

1894

1978

Jessie Smith
1821 S 9th
Terre Haute, Indiana

Wife

812-235-7795

DeBaun Funeral Home Inc
1729 S 8th
Terre Haute, Indiana

812
235-8046

Roselawn Memorial Park Terre Haute, Ind

APPLICATION FOR HEADSTONE OR MARKER

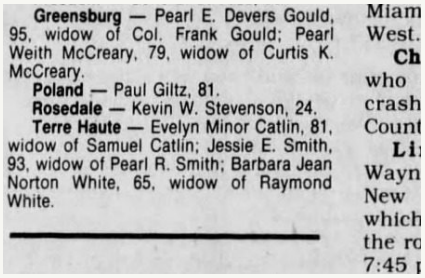
The application for Pearl Ruby Smith's government marker, signed by Jessie E. Smith on 16 March 1978: Private, Army, service number 1 986 564, 21 September 1917 to 18 April 1919, World War I, a flat granite marker with a Latin cross, Roselawn Memorial Park; DeBaun Funeral Home, consignee. National Archives, via Ancestry.



Pearl R. Smith, Pvt US Army, World War I, 1894 to 1978, Roselawn Memorial Park, Terre Haute. Find a Grave.



Jessie E. Smith, 1898 to 1991, Roselawn Memorial Park. Find a Grave.



Greensburg — Pearl E. Devers Gould, 95, widow of Col. Frank Gould; Pearl Weith McCreary, 79, widow of Curtis K. McCreary.
Poland — Paul Giltz, 81.
Rosedale — Kevin W. Stevenson, 24.
Terre Haute — Evelyn Minor Catlin, 81, widow of Samuel Catlin; Jessie E. Smith, 93, widow of Pearl R. Smith; Barbara Jean Norton White, 65, widow of Raymond White.

Miam West. Ch who crash Count Li Wayn New which the ro 7:45 p

The Indianapolis Star, 3 September 1991, Indiana deaths: 'Terre Haute: Jessie E. Smith, 93, widow of Pearl R. Smith.' Newspapers.com.



Garrett Smith, 1873 to 1950, Oak Hill Cemetery, Riley. Find a Grave, photograph by Sandra Hayes.



Sarah E. Smith, 1875 to 1923, Oak Hill Cemetery, Riley. Find a Grave, photograph by Sandra Hayes.



Dora Eversole Hults, 11 November 1864 to 23 June 1928, Mount Pleasant Cemetery, Terre Haute: 'The cross leads generations on.' Find a Grave, photograph by Kerri Slaton.



Landing Zone English, the 173d Airborne Brigade's base in Binh Dinh province, about 55 miles north of Qui Nhon, 23 July 1970: a trooper on a grader cuts off the path of a fire at the fuel point. Michael's base, in his year there. U.S. Army photograph by SP5 Roy Tronnes, 111-CCV-224-CC72574, National Archives.



A UH-1D of the 61st Assault Helicopter Company puts a long-range reconnaissance patrol of the 173d Airborne Brigade into a landing zone 17 miles south of LZ English, 29 September 1970, the month before the night Michael was wounded. U.S. Army photograph by SP4 John Atkinson, 111-CCV-97-CC658870, National Archives.



The shoulder sleeve insignia of the 173d Airborne Brigade, the Sky Soldiers, worn by Michael in Vietnam. The Institute of Heraldry, U.S. Army.

RECORDS

Sources

1. The Terre Haute Star, 10 December 1949, p. 5, Births: Michael Bauer Smith, born 2 December at St. Anthony's Hospital (Newspapers.com)
2. 1950 United States census, Terre Haute, 43 South 15th Street, sheet begun 3 April 1950: Ralph W. Smith, Patricia A. and Michael B., upstairs from Anton J. Bauer Jr. (Ancestry)
3. The same 1950 census sheet as an image (Ancestry)
4. Terre Haute Tribune, 4 September 1949, p. 30, classified advertisement for rooms at 43 S. 15th (Newspapers.com)
5. Indiana birth certificate no. 26489, Ralph Warn Smith, 28 May 1926, parents Pearl R. Smith, coal miner, and Jessie E. Hults (Ancestry)
6. The same birth certificate as an image (Ancestry)
7. 1930 United States census, Honey Creek Township, Spring Hill Road: Pearl R. Smith household (Ancestry)
8. 1940 United States census, Honey Creek Township: Pearl R. Smith household, 'Warren R Smith,' 13 (Ancestry)
9. World War II draft registration card, Ralph Warren Smith, 15 May 1944, front and back (Ancestry)
10. U.S. Army enlistment record, Ralph W. Smith, 35908327, Indianapolis, 9 September 1944 (Ancestry)

11. Selective Service registration card, Ralph W. Smith, 8 September 1948: Commercial Solvents watchman; active duty 9 Sep 1944 to 22 Nov 1946, 1st Cavalry Division (Fold3, images 735512373 and 741631861)

12. The same 1948 card in the Ancestry index (Ancestry)

13. Department of Veterans Affairs BIRLS death file, Ralph W. Smith, Army, 9 Sep 1944 to 22 Nov 1946 (Ancestry)

14. Indiana marriages: Ralph W. Smith and Florence Jane Francis, 26 January 1945 (Ancestry)

15. Indiana marriages: Ralph W. Smith and Patricia A. Bauer, 28 May 1948, license by Samuel C. McQueen, Clay County (Ancestry)

16. Terre Haute Tribune, 13 June 1948, p. 33, 'Licensed at Brazil': Ralph W. Smith and Patricia A. Bauer (Newspapers.com)

17. Indiana marriage certificate 25571: Ralph Warren Smith and Florence Jane Fields, 18 August 2005 (Ancestry)

18. San Jose city and suburban directories, 1969 and 1974: Ralph W. Smith, technician, 2961 Mark Av, Santa Clara, with Patricia (Ancestry)

19. Indiana death certificate 006411, Ralph Warren Smith, 7 February 2012 (Ancestry)

20. Ralph W. Smith obituary, Terre Haute Tribune-Star, 10 February 2012

21. Ralph W. Smith funeral notice, San Jose Mercury News, 12 February 2012 (Legacy.com)

22. Find a Grave memorial 97589809, Ralph Warren Smith, Santa Clara Mission Cemetery, with his portrait

23. Flag raising by the 12th Cavalry, 1st Cavalry Division, Manila Hotel, 23 February 1945, Signal Corps photograph 111-SC-202169 (National Archives)

24. Members of the 1st Cavalry guard Japanese prisoners at Santo Tomas, Manila, U.S. Air Force photograph 82271AC (National Archives)

25. First Cavalry Division review in Tokyo, 12 May 1946, Signal Corps photographs, Harry S. Truman Library (National Archives)

26. Hoctor Ancestry Records tree: Ralph Warren Smith, Pearl Ruby Smith, Jessie Ethel Hults, Garrett R. Smith, Sarah Elizabeth Killen (Ancestry)

27. Indiana birth certificate, Patricia Bauer, 1 March 1928, Terre Haute (Ancestry; image)

28. Patricia Bauer in the 1930 census (age 2) and 1940 census (age 12), 1100 Poplar Street (Ancestry)

29. Social Security Death Index: Patricia B. Smith, 1 March 1928 to 12 July 2002, Santa Clara (Ancestry)

30. Smith Family Tree: Anton P. Bauer, born 7 May 1883 Frauendorf, with parents, siblings and eleven children (Ancestry)

31. World War I draft registration card, Anton P. Bauer, 1100 Poplar Street, 12 September 1918 (Ancestry)

32. World War II draft registration card, Anton P. Bauer, born Frauendorf, Austria, 7 May 1883 (Ancestry)

33. Anton Bauer in the censuses of 1910 (309 Poplar), 1920, 1930, 1940 and 1950 (1100 Poplar) (Ancestry)

34. Indiana death certificate, Anton Bauer Sr., 2 March 1977, parents Florian Bauer and Barbara Crites (Ancestry)

35. Naturalization index, Anton Bauer, born 1883 Austria, Milwaukee, 14 June 1906, probably a different man (Ancestry)

36. Terre Haute Tribune, 30 January 1954, p. 11, service directory: 'Upholstering, refinishing and repairs, Anton Bauer, 1100 Poplar' (Newspapers.com)

37. Terre Haute Tribune, 10 May 1971, p. 4, 'The Nosey News Hawk': Anton Bauer's 88th birthday (Newspapers.com)

38. Find a Grave memorial 31196505, Anton Joseph Bauer Sr., Calvary Cemetery, with Ida Belle (31196506)

39. Indiana death certificate, Ida Belle Bauer, 25 March 1973, parents Jacob Beam and Emma Alice Winters (Ancestry)

40. Terre Haute Tribune, 26 March 1973, p. 2: Mrs. Ida Belle Bauer, arrangements pending (Newspapers.com)

41. Terre Haute Tribune, 27 March 1973, p. 2: Mrs. Ida Belle Bauer, services (Newspapers.com)

42. 1900 United States census, Terre Haute, 1910 Eighteenth Street: Jacob Beam, wagon maker, Ema, Lillian, Ruby and James (Ancestry)

43. Indiana marriage index: Emma A. Winters and Jacob Beam, 12 November 1888, Vigo County (Ancestry)

44. Indiana death certificate, Pearl Ruby Smith, 15 March 1978, parents Garrett Smith and Sarah Killen (Ancestry)

45. World War I draft registration card, Pearl Ruby Smith, 5 June 1917 (Ancestry)

46. Headstone application, Pearl Ruby Smith, Private, 1 986 564, 21 September 1917 to 18 April 1919, signed by Jessie E. Smith, 16 March 1978 (Ancestry)

47. Review of the 84th Division at Camp Zachary Taylor, 10 November 1917, 165-PP-9-5 (National Archives)

48. Views at Various Camps: General View of Camp Zachary Taylor, Ky., 111-SC-68027 (National Archives)

49. Indiana marriages: Pearl R. Smith and Jessie E. Hults, 24 November 1917 (Ancestry)

50. Indiana marriages: Pearl R. Smith and Jessie E. Smith, 8 November 1945, Terre Haute (Ancestry)

51. Find a Grave memorial 157760696, Pearl Ruby Smith, Roselawn Memorial Park, with Jessie E. Hults Smith (157760794)

52. Indiana death certificate, Jessie E. Smith, 1 September 1991, parents Jennus Hults and Dora Eversole (Ancestry)

53. Indianapolis Star, 3 September 1991, p. 12, Indiana deaths: 'Jessie E. Smith, 93, widow of Pearl R. Smith' (Newspapers.com)

54. 1900 United States census, Lost Creek Township: 'Gerris Hultz,' Dora, Jessie, Leland, Floyd and Earnest (Ancestry)

55. Sherer, McGee, Bartlett, Eversole family tree: Jessie E. Hults, parents Jennis Hubble Hults and Emma Dora Eversole, the 1944 divorce and 1945 remarriage (Ancestry)

56. Find a Grave memorial 65305299, Dora Eversole Hults, Mount Pleasant Cemetery

57. Indiana compiled marriages: Christopher Eversole and Nancy Latta, 4 November 1841, Vigo County (Ancestry)

58. 1900 United States census, Honey Creek Township: Garret Smith, farm laborer, Sarah, Robert, Pearl, Mabell and Hazel (Ancestry)

59. Find a Grave memorials 73840011 and 73840444, Garrett R. 'Codge' Smith and Sarah Elizabeth Killen Smith, Oak Hill Cemetery, Riley

50. Kentucky birth records: Sarah E. Killen, 16 January 1875, Larue County; Kentucky marriages: Christopher Killen and Nancy A. Despain, 5 March 1874 (Ancestry)
51. Kentucky compiled marriages: Abraham Smith and Sarah McKinley, Bracken County, 26 November 1811 (Ancestry)
52. Frauendorf (Gemeinde Traismauer), German Wikipedia
53. Parish of Stollhofen, Diocese of St. Poelten, registers on Matricula Online; Taufbuch 01/08 covers 1881 to 1907
54. Commercial Solvents Corporation, Terre Haute (Wikipedia)
55. United Technology Center, Sunnyvale, and the Coyote Valley plant (Encyclopedia Astronautica; Morgan Hill Times)
56. 1st Cavalry Division in the Philippines and the occupation of Japan (Wikipedia)
57. Betty Smith, died 13 February 2021, arrangements by Skylawn Funeral Home, San Mateo (Michael's Betty: his memoir gives the day before Valentine's Day in the pandemic year)
58. Michael B. Smith Sr., Echoes of a Sky Soldier (working title Hunger for Survival), his memoir, written with Branding by Books, 2024 to 2026: chapters 1 to 26, epilogue and interview notes; the family's copy
59. 173rd Airborne Brigade in Vietnam, 1965 to 1971 (Wikipedia)
70. Members of the 2nd Battalion, 503rd Infantry, 173rd Airborne Brigade, 50 km northwest of Bong Son, 29 March 1970, U.S. Army photograph 111-CCV-637-CC67687 (National Archives, via Wikimedia Commons)
71. Landing Zone English, 23 July 1970, U.S. Army photograph 111-CCV-224-CC72574 (National Archives, via Wikimedia Commons)
72. UH-1D inserting a 173rd Airborne Brigade long-range reconnaissance patrol 17 miles south of LZ English, 29 September 1970, U.S. Army photograph 111-CCV-97-CC658870 (National Archives, via Wikimedia Commons)
73. Shoulder sleeve insignia of the 173rd Airborne Brigade, The Institute of Heraldry (via Wikimedia Commons)
74. Robert Charles Goodwin, 1925 to 2014, Betty's father, on his own page
75. Goodwin & Oviatt Lines, the family page for Bobby Goodwin

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Part of Goodwin & Oviatt Lines. Photographs of graves are reproduced from Find a Grave and remain their photographers'; the portrait of Ralph Warren Smith was posted to his memorial by a family friend and remains the family's. The draft cards, certificates and census sheets are public records held by the National Archives and the Indiana Archives; the Signal Corps, Air Force and Army photographs, including those of the 173d Airborne Brigade, are United States government works in the public domain; the newspaper clippings are reproduced from Newspapers.com for family use. Nothing on this page about living people goes beyond what the family has chosen to say, and Michael's own chapters follow his memoir.